

ECO n329 ECONOMIC STATISTICS-WB

Unique Number 79155

Summer 2025 Syllabus

1 Key Contact Information

Assistant Instructor: Mr. Ziheng Yu
Email: ziheng.yu@utexas.edu
- I tend to check my inbox multiple times during the day on each weekday and usually reply within minutes or hours.
Problem-Solving Sessions: MW 11 am - 12 pm, via Zoom at <https://utexas.zoom.us/j/99989433839>
Office Hours: by email appointments, via Zoom
- link will be sent with appointment confirmation via email

Teaching Assistant: Mr. Koichi Onogi
Email: konogi@utexas.edu
Office Hours: T 8 - 9 am, via Zoom at <https://utexas.zoom.us/j/7397317807>
Mr. Dongyun Yang
Email: ydgii@utexas.edu
Office Hours: W 8 - 9 pm, via Zoom at <https://utexas.zoom.us/j/95970282573>

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2 Course Description

2.1 Overview

Welcome to ECO 329, which is an introductory course in probability and statistics and may be your first course in quantitative methods at the upper level of the economics course sequence. The objective of this course is to prepare students for further studies of econometrics by providing students with (1) basic knowledge about interpretation of economic data, (2) an introduction to statistical models, estimation, and inference in economics, and (3) instances involving combinations of theoretical statistics and mathematical background with real-life data analysis skills in economics and business situations. In detail, this course is expected to provide you with:

- Statistics foundation, via exploring methods for describing data;
- Theoretical background, via introducing a variety of statistical methods used to draw conclusions from economic data and exposing students to the conceptual and mathematical foundations of these methods;
- Applicability of theoretical tools, via exploring data analysis skills, e.g., how to build and analyze probability models that can be applied to real-life economic and business situations.

2.2 Prerequisites

- Economics 304K and 304L with a grade of at least a C- in each;
- Mathematics 408Q, or Mathematics 408K and 408L, or 408C and 408D, or 408C and 408L, or 408N and 408S, or 408K and 408S, or 408C and 408S, or 408L and 408R, or 408R and 408S, or 408L and 408N, with a grade of at least C- in each.

2.3 Activities

You need to be aware of and participate in the following course activities so as to succeed in this course.

- Watch lecture recordings posted in Canvas modules, do the associated reading in the textbook, and complete the relevant InstaPolls.
- Complete the Canvas quizzes before their respective due times (11:59 pm CDT on their respective due dates).
- Complete three asynchronous exams (2 midterms and 1 final exam) on Gradescope (accessible via Canvas) within their respective time windows before their respective due times.

All of the lecture recordings and quizzes have been posted on Canvas, and you are free to do the relevant work at your own pace (conditional on the constraints imposed by the relevant deadlines). For each exam, the respective exam questions will be accessible to you on Gradescope (which is accessible on Canvas as well) once you start your own exam there.

2.4 Contents

These course materials are divided into 10 topics (each with a Canvas module containing corresponding lecture recordings and relevant materials), which are categorized into 3 segments.

- Segment 1: Introduction, Descriptive Statistics, and Basic Probability Theory

This segment consists of topics 1 - 4.

- Topic 1 is an introduction to this course and exposes you to some basic sense of statistical data and random variables.

- Topic 2 - 3 cover methods for describing the distribution of data associated with one or more random variables, including measures of central tendency and dispersion, correlation, frequency distributions, percentiles, and histograms.
- Topic 4 covers the set-theoretic foundations of probability and the axioms of probability as well as associated materials including Bayes' Rule, counting rules, and joint probability distributions.

Midterm 1 will cover the materials covered in segment 1.

- Segment 2: Random Variables and Sampling Theory

This segment consists of topics 5 - 7 (for topic 7, part 1 only).

- Topics 5 - 6 cover various discrete and continuous random variables that allow us to compute probabilities of events and do further econometric analysis (e.g., hypothesis testing, which is to be covered in subsequent topics).
- Topic 7 covers sampling theory, which builds probability models of the impact of randomness in the data generating process on statistics we compute from data.

Midterm 2 is non-cumulative and will only cover the materials covered in segment 2.

- Segment 3: Estimation and Hypothesis Testing

This segment consists of topics 7 (part 2, which is still about sampling theory) - 10.

- Topic 8 covers estimation methods, which are based on sampling distributions and the relevant theorems.
- Topic 9 - 10 cover hypothesis testing about both one parameter of a single population and the relationship between parameters across two populations.

The final exam is cumulative and will cover all materials covered in segments 1 - 3.

3 Course Materials and Resources

3.1 Textbook

The required textbook of this course is

Jay L. Devore, *Probability and Statistics for Engineering and the Sciences, 9th Edition*, Cengage.

You do not need access to WebAssign for this course.

Any way of acquiring the textbook is fine (hard-cover or loose-leaf version or e-book, new or used). For your reference, the textbook is available through the Longhorn Textbook Access (LTA) program, a collaboration between UT Austin, The University Co-op and textbook publishers to significantly reduce the cost of digital course materials for students. You can access your required materials through the “My Textbooks” tab on Canvas. You are automatically opted into the program but can easily opt-out (and back in) via Canvas through the 4th class day. If you remain opted-in at the end of the add/drop period (4th class day summer sessions), you will receive a bill through your “What I Owe” page. If you do not pay your bill by the specified deadline, you will lose access to the course materials and your charge will be removed. More information about the LTA program is available at Longhorn Textbook Access website.

3.2 Lecture Recordings and Slides

The lecture videos were pre-recorded by Dr. V.R. Bencivenga, who had also provided the links to the slides used for the lectures. Both lecture recordings and the relevant slides are accessible via the corresponding Canvas module, and you can watch each video as many times as you want. In the module of each topic:

- The first item, titled “TOPIC X - Topic name”, consists of all slides for the lecture recordings on the corresponding topic.
 - Such items also provide access to some extra questions and optional slides, but please note that these extra materials are only for practice and further reference. You are only responsible for materials covered in the lecture recordings (and their associated slides) in the exams.
- The other items, titled “(Part Y, Lecture Z:) Subject”, will redirect you to new pages where you would be able to watch the lecture recording and complete the associated InstaPolls during your watching process.

Please note that you are responsible for ALL materials covered in the lectures.

In addition, for your reference, in a Canvas module titled “Schedule of course work and other information” there is a PDF file titled

“ECO 329 Lecture Videos & Reading Correspondence ASYNCHRONOUS ONLINE COURSE.pdf”

that provides a correspondence among lecture recordings, lecture slides, and textbook readings, according to which you could locate the readings associated with each video.

3.3 Problem-Solving Sessions (Optional)

Each week I will hold two Zoom problem-solving sessions (time and Zoom link findable on the first page of the syllabus - please note that you’ll need to be logged in with your UT-Austin-affiliated email so as to be able to enter the Zoom meeting room) that you can attend synchronously and ask questions. The sessions are analogous to office hours except that they will be RECORDED (findable on Canvas via “Zoom” tab).

Please note that such problem-solving sessions are different from traditional “review sessions” in which session leaders straightforwardly go over specific prepared materials (e.g., homework or extra practice problems) prepared by their own. Instead, you are supposed to request me to cover specific contents in the sessions in the following ways.

- Attending the session synchronously and directly asking questions;
- Emailing me beforehand (at least one day ahead of time) to indicate that you hope to have me cover something (and tell me what it is) in the session without your presence so that you could watch the recorded presentation later.

Also, the contents eligible to be covered in the sessions are as follows.

- Lecture-related questions about videos not too far ahead of time (e.g., please don’t have me cover some segment 2 content in the very first session);
- Quiz questions - please note that, for the sake of fairness, in such recorded sessions I will only cover questions in quizzes due before the session;
- Questions from graded exams;
- Extra practice problems, either from those provided on Canvas or collected elsewhere;
- Other questions that are not on top of my head - please always feel free to ask whether something could be covered in such recorded sessions regardless of whether my response would tend to be yes or no.

Besides, please be aware of the following (rather logistical) things regarding the problem-solving sessions.

- Synchronous questions will have priority over email requests. I will privately respond to requests via email if the synchronous attendance of a session is unexpectedly so high that I can't clear up all email requests during the recorded session.
- However, when you enter the Zoom meeting to join the session, if you find that I'm presenting something that you don't have any relevant question, please stay (and watch if you would like to) and wait until I finish the presentation before asking your own questions - I don't mind moderately work overtime to take some synchronous questions before leaving for lunch. Nevertheless, if you also have some concern about what I'm presenting, please feel free to directly jump in and ask about it.
- When there are multiple synchronous attendees in the session, please expect that we will rotate so that everyone could have chance to ask his or her own questions.

3.4 Office Hours (Optional)

Each of the teaching assistants will hold a one-hour regular office hour per week (time and Zoom links findable on the first page of the syllabus). I could also hold extra office hours if needed - in this case please email me at least 24 hours ahead of time to request an extra office hour and schedule beforehand. Unlike the problem-solving sessions, the office hours will NOT be recorded, so please opt to office hours if you would like to have private face-to-face communications with any of us.

3.5 Extra Practice Problems (Optional)

In addition to the extra practice problems for each topic mentioned above, there are also extra ones for each segment put in Canvas modules titled "SEGMENT A: Practice exams/homework for Segment A (Topics B - C)". However, please be aware that these extra problems are posted purely for your reference and practice, and you are NOT responsible for them in the exams.

3.6 Suggestions on Pace and Flow of Your Work

In the Canvas module titled "Schedule of course work and other information", there are two files other than the "READ FIRST" page and video-reading correspondence. Below is a brief introduction to the two files.

- "ECO 329 Teaching & Learning Plan Summer 2025.xlsx"

This spreadsheet suggests a schedule for viewing the lecture videos (including two videos of review questions on Topic 5 and Topic 7 respectively). It gives due dates for the quizzes, exam dates, and dates for problem-solving sessions. It also lists specific (optional) practice problems that you could study along with every topic and sub-topic (video). Links to practice problems are in the Canvas modules of the corresponding topics/segments.

- "ECO 329 Timetable Summer 2025.pdf"

This PDF file is a streamlined and expurgated version of the spreadsheet above in that it only contains all content-and-time-related information (quiz deadlines, exam dates, suggested time for watching lecture recordings, time for problem-solving sessions - and in addition, it also contains time for office hours, which is not included in the spreadsheet) shown in the spreadsheet. This file is compiled as a set of reminders for your quick reference.

4 Assessments

4.1 Quizzes: 20%

The Canvas quizzes are with different due times and considered as substitutes for traditional homework (problem sets). They all due at 11:59 pm CDT on their respective due dates and will be closed after the

deadline - that is, you will no longer be able to do the quizzes after their respective deadlines. A no-attempt of any of your quizzes will result in a 0 score of the corresponding quiz.

Please be aware that each quiz gives you two attempts and the latest (last) attempt counts, NOT your higher score. Also, both the point values of quiz questions and the number of questions in quizzes (and thus, the total points of quizzes) vary. Your answer to each single quiz question is either correct (full points) or incorrect (zero points). For each of you, two lowest (in terms of percentage, not absolute value) quiz scores will be dropped in the calculation of your respective gross numerical grades.

- For instance, consider a simplified case where there are 4 quizzes (not for this course, where we have 19 quizzes) and a student scores (1) 18 out of 20 (90%), (2) 30 out of 40 (75%), (3) 90 out of 110 (81.8%), and (4) 14 out of 14 (100%) respectively, then quizzes #2 and #3, who are with lower percentage values of scores (despite their higher absolute values), will be dropped.

Also, for your reference, for each quiz, The title contains a brief sketch of the covered content as well as the topic to which the content belongs, and the quiz questions are also posted in the first item of the corresponding topic's module. Thus, please feel free to download the questions and solve them before opening the quiz - I personally recommend downloading beforehand because opening a Canvas quiz counts as an attempt. Besides, you may work together on the quizzes, but I strongly recommend that you make sure that you understand every solution by making use of the associated learning opportunities so as to better prepare yourselves for the exams.

Finally, the answers to quiz questions will be presented (and recorded) in Zoom problem-solving sessions upon your request but will NOT be posted on Canvas (neither for a neatly typed answer key file - there is no such answer key - nor for a worksheet containing my draft used in my Zoom presentation - such worksheets are findable in the Zoom recordings).

4.2 Exams: 80% [20% (MT1) + 25% (MT2) + 35% (Final)]

4.2.1 Process

This section is composed in case some of you haven't taken any exam on Gradescope. A step-by-step description of the process is described below. Also, there is a exam assignment on Gradescope titled "Gradescope Exercise (NOT count in final grade)" via which you could try and go through the process by yourself before the assignment dues. Please feel free to try anything you want there as this assignment will NOT count in your final grade calculation.

When you open an exam assignment on Canvas, you'll see a button that redirects you to Gradescope (or you could directly head to Gradescope via the Canvas tab). On the Gradescope dashboard of this course you will find a corresponding exam assignment, and after clicking the exam assignment you will see a page with Gradescope-relevant instructions before starting your exam. This instruction page contains information about the time window for the exam, a "late due date", and the maximum time you could have for working on the exam AND upload your answers. You will start the exam (and the countdown) by clicking the "Start Assignment" button on the page.

Your clicking the button will bring you to a new page, where you will be able to

- find the countdown timer in the top right corner,
- download the exam question sheet via the link in a box titled "Your instructor has provided a PDF to help you complete your assignment." - the question sheet will be a PDF file with multiple multi-part questions - and
- submit your write-up via either the "Submit Images" or the "Submit PDF" button.

Please be sure to download the exam questions sheet (and print it out if you think a hard copy helps in any aspect) before start working in case any unexpected accident happens, as the countdown starts once you start your exam and will never pause even though you leave the Gradescope page (either actively or accidentally).

As for submission, you shall handwrite (on paper or tablet or somehow else, but NOT type) your own solution, take clear and legible pictures of all your work on paper (if any), and (1) directly submit the pictures (images) OR (2) make a SINGLE PDF file of your answers (by using a scanning app or a “JPG to PDF” app - such as <https://smallpdf.com/jpg-to-pdf> - or directly outputting a PDF file from your tablet or other devices) and submit the PDF. You are responsible for the legibility of ALL files in your submission.

If you choose to submit images, you will be redirected to a page that requires you to upload image files that contain you answer to EACH question in the exam - that is, for instance, in a exam with 3 questions, you will need to submit 3 sets of images - please be sure that you don’t mix it up (e.g., don’t select the set of images containing your answer to only Q2 for the submission associated with Q1). Then, you are supposed to click the “Submit Assignment” button to complete this submission of yours.

If you choose to submit PDF, you will be redirected to a page that requires you to upload a SINGLE PDF file that contains your answers to ALL exam questions. Then, you need to proceed to the next page by clicking the “Upload PDF” button, and on the new page you need to select (probably different) pages of your PDF file for different exam question (by, e.g., first clicking the exam question and then clicking ALL of the corresponding PDF pages that contain your answer to that question) - please be sure to do this as it (1) provides you with an opportunity to double-check that you include the whole set of your answers in your submission and (2) makes grading easier. After selecting pages for all exam questions, you are supposed to click the “Submit” button in the bottom right corner of this page-selection page to complete this submission of yours. Please note that you can only choose to submit EITHER sets of images OR a PDF, but NOT a combination of the two.

After you complete a submission of yours, you will be redirected to a page that pops up a confirmation of successful submission and shows your submitted file(s) - if you accidentally leave the page, you could get back to it by clicking the exam assignment on the dashboard. Also, on the page you could click the “Resubmit” button in the bottom right corner of this new page to complete another submission of yours. Finally, please be aware that Gradescope allows for infinite attempts - but ONLY BEFORE your countdown ends - and only the LATEST (last) submitted file(s) of yours will remain (be stored) in the system of Gradescope to be graded as your final submission of the exam assignment.

4.2.2 Logistics

Firstly, all of the exams will be open-book, open-notes, without proctoring, and taken on Gradescope. There will be a 24-hour time window for each exam, from 0:00 am to 11:59 pm CDT (i.e., UTC –5) on the respective exam dates. An overview of basic information about the exams are as follows.

Exam	Time Window (All in CDT, i.e., UTC –5)	Max Total Time Length
Midterm #1	00:00 am - 11:59 pm on Wednesday, 6/18	90 minutes
Midterm #2	00:00 am - 11:59 pm on Wednesday, 7/9	90 minutes
Final Exam	00:00 am - 11:59 pm on Wednesday, 7/30	140 minutes

Please note that the maximum total time length for each exam includes time for the exam downloading question sheet (5 minutes for each exam) as well as making and uploading your answer file(s) (10 minutes for each midterm, 15 minutes for final). Thus, the exam questions are designed such that you are expected to finish answering all exam questions within 75 minutes for each midterm and within 120 minutes for the final.

I reserve the right to reject any late submission, and a rejected submission will result in a weight adjustment in either of the midterms and a 0 score in the final exam. However, as is mentioned in the previous section,

there will be a “late due date” officially set on Gradescope for each exam. This is for the sake of accommodating those of you who may encounter technical difficulties - please note that it is your own responsibility to secure a good technical environment, including internet connection, for yourself in such an internet-base course. I don’t mind accepting submissions that are only slightly (say 5-10 minutes) late in terms of the time window, and if any extremely horrible case happens to you after you start your exam and download the question sheet, please continue to work on the exam questions if possible and, if you can’t complete the exam or situation is still bad after your completion, please email me as soon as possible, clearly describe your situation, offer relevant evidence if applicable (e.g., medical record), and attach the set of your answer file(s) to the email. Lastly, even though the time window constraint could be softened by the late due date, the max time length constraint is tightly applied to everyone and will not be softened - once you start the exam, the countdown will still be happening on Gradescope despite any technical difficulty, and you will NOT be able to make any submission after the countdown ends.

Although the exams are open-book, open-notes, and will not be proctored, each of you shall follow the honor code that (1) you will work independently in that you don’t, except for asking the TAs or me for clarifications, discuss the exam questions with anyone else (regardless of whether the person is enrolled in this course or not and whether the person has finished his or her own exam or not) and (2) you will not use any web search engine to search for explanation of concepts or solution to exam questions (you are supposed to use textbook, materials on the course Canvas page, and your own notes for reference).

On each exam day please feel free to email the TAs and me (ideally all three of us so as to get response as quickly as possible) for questions (e.g., clarifications). We will answer as many questions as we can as quickly as possible and may post clarifications via Canvas announcements if necessary. For your reference, I will surely be fully on standby between 10 am and 5 pm CDT on each exam day, including face-to-face availability in the problem-solving session (that will be held only for the sake of troubleshooting and clarification on exam dates).

4.2.3 Grading Criteria, Answer Key, and Possible Regrade Requests

You are supposed to show sufficiently many details of your work to earn points in your exams. You do not have to show every step (e.g., don’t submit your scratch paper), but you must show enough work for us (as graders) to follow your logic. For each exam, after grades are posted, you will find rubric items along with your graded exams on Gradescope that correspond to the points that you have earned/lost in each exam question. From the rubric you will see that (1) most points are awarded to the intermediate work of yours and (2) calculation errors tend to make you lose relatively few points.

The answer key (with rubric) to each exam will be posted (in a Canvas module titled “Exam answer keys (with rubric) - to be posted along with the respective grades”) along with the grades of the corresponding exam. The grades and answer keys will be posted no later than 1 pm CDT of a day (the date will depend on the progress of grading), and you will have until the end of the same day (before 11:59 pm CDT) to submit your regrade requests on Gradescope. All regrading concerns will be settled no later than the end of the next day, after which all grades of the exam should be considered as final.

- For example, for a exam with grades posted at 12 pm on June 20th, you will have until 11:59 pm CDT on June 20th to request relevant regrading. Then, we will finish the discussion on regrading before 11:59 pm CDT on June 21st, and all grades of that exam on file on June 22nd should be considered as final.

4.2.4 Policies on Absence and Accommodations

For every one of you:

- Please let me know as soon as possible if you don’t think some of the designated 24 hour windows work for you for either/both midterms and/or the final exam. In this case I can arrange a specific window for each of you before the designated 24 hour window on the exam day, but NOT after.

If you have known about your conflict in advance, please let me know about it right away so as to minimize the inconvenience that may be result from your being not sufficiently well organized to inform me about your situation.

- There will be NO make-up for any of the exams. If you have any reason for your absence from either (or both) midterm, the weight on the missed midterm(s) will be directly added to that of your final exam in the calculation of your gross numerical grade.

You do NOT need to contact the TAs or me for the weight adjustment regardless of the reason for your absence from the midterm(s). The corresponding weight will be automatically adjusted in the calculation of your gross numerical grade upon the no-submission (or rejection) of any of your midterms - please note that a 0 score of any of your midterms will NOT result in any weight adjustment.

However (and unfortunately), you CANNOT rightfully miss the final exam unless your absence is in accordance to the Class Absence Notification Request or other relevant materials from the office of the dean of the students (<https://deanofstudents.utexas.edu/sos/index.php>).

Please note that it is unlikely for you to gain a decent grade in this course with your unrightful absence from the final exam - such absence will result in a 0 score of your final exam.

- If you have extended time in your accommodations letter from Disabilities and Access (D&A), I will give additional time (in terms of length but not window if there is no separate request) on each of your exams in Canvas in accordance to your accommodation. You need to email me a PDF of your accommodation letter to have your extended time granted, and I'll reply to initiate the discussion about how the accommodation will be provided.

Please note that students with accommodations are responsible for contacting me directly, providing a PDF of the accommodation letter, letting me know which accommodation they would like to use, and discussing with me how the accommodations will be provided - the notice I receive from D&A that your accommodation letter is available in the portal is NOT sufficient.

4.2.5 Tips

It is highly recommended (but optional) that you prepare a “cheat sheet” consisting of key concepts so as to save you some time (possibly cost by your looking into textbook, slides, and/or notes) during the exam. For your reference, there is a Canvas module titled “Formula sheets and probability tables for exams” that consists of relevant materials that you can directly use in exams and/or compile your own cheat sheets accordingly.

Also, there are multiple semesters of old exams findable in Canvas modules, and you can use them for practice in terms of both contents and time control. As far as I'm concerned, your exams will probably be comparable (in terms of length and difficulty, but not necessarily in terms of emphasis on contents) to those from Summer 2023 and Summer 2024.

4.3 InstaPolls: 1% (Bonus)

There are InstaPoll (pop-up) multiple choice questions embedded in the lecture recording videos. InstaPolls may pop up during the videos or at the end. Although you may watch the lecture recordings for multiple times, the InstaPolls vanish once you pass them - when an InstaPoll pops up, that is your only opportunity to answer it. Once you answer, it vanishes permanently.

The responses to InstaPolls will be collected and scored on July 31st, so you need to finish watching the videos and answer the pop-up questions by then to earn the relevant points. I strongly recommend that you finish them by July 29th, i.e., before the final exam date, so as to have enough time to digest, reflect and ask relevant questions (if any). Because there is no phase-by-phase deadlines for InstaPolls (unlike quizzes), answers to InstaPoll questions will NOT be posted or covered in problem-solving sessions – but you are welcome to email us about InstaPolls or ask us about them in office hours after you have watched the relevant recordings.

The InstaPolls will be graded by correctness. There are 125 of them in total, and each of them counts equally though they vary in nature and in how long it will take for you to do them. The points associated with InstaPolls are considered as bonus points (that are not in the regular 100%-point framework) in that you will earn an extra $\frac{x}{100}\%$ on your gross numerical grade from the accuracy of $x\%$ of your overall answers to the InstaPoll questions.

For your reference, below are some tips about prevention from possible technical issues related to the lecture recordings and InstaPolls (so that you could avoid missing/losing InstaPolls due to them - please note that a missed InstaPoll question is equivalent to an incorrectly answered one in the grade calculation).

- Do not scroll ahead or click ahead in the video. Any InstaPoll you pass will be lost permanently.
- If you want to watch the videos in full screen mode, use the video player expand function in the video player (a small “expand” button). Do not move to full-screen mode by double-clicking, which layers a browser function on top of the video player. If you do this, the InstaPolls may not pop up. Although you can re-watch the video and receive the InstaPolls, you don’t know where the InstaPolls are located in the video, and you may not want to re-watch the entire video.
- If your video “times out” (in cases where you leave it open for a while and a message appears), follow the instruction about refreshing your browser.
- Do not use a browser plug-in that alters the speed of the video. If you do, and if there are multiple InstaPolls, one right after another (which happens frequently), they may “stack” and you’ll see only the last one (one or more earlier InstaPolls may be hidden underneath, and there is no way for you to go back to them).
- You can stop a lecture video partway through and continue it later.
- Most of the InstaPolls will ask you to click on a link to a file in order to see the question-and-answer choices. This is because equations, graphs, and long questions don’t fit in the InstaPoll question box. Return to the InstaPoll to give your answer.
- Turn off your ad-blocker. It might cause your InstaPoll not pop-up.
- Do follow the instructions carefully. For some InstaPolls there are instructions about which question in a set to answer - you don’t want to accidentally answer the wrong one.

4.4 From Raw Grades to Gross Numerical Grade and Letter Grade

- Below is the formula applied to calculate gross numerical grade from raw grades:

$$N = p + 20 \times \frac{1}{17} \sum_{i=1}^{17} q_i + 0.35f + \begin{cases} 0.2m_1 + 0.25m_2 & \text{upon no absence from midterms} \\ 0.2f + 0.25m_2 & \text{upon absence from midterm 1 only} \\ 0.2m_1 + 0.25f & \text{upon absence from midterm 2 only} \\ 0.45f & \text{upon absence from both midterms} \end{cases},$$

where N is your gross numerical grade,

p is the overall accuracy of your answers to the InstaPoll questions,

q_i is your i – th highest quiz score (in percentage) for all $i \in \{1, 2, \dots, 17\}$,

m_j is the score of your midterm j for each $j \in \{1, 2\}$, and

f is the score of your final exam (each exam will be with 100 points in total).

- Please note that your letter grade (that will appear on your grade report) will probably not be directly derived from your gross numerical grade. Instead, your gross numerical grade may be curved up according to the following formula:

$$\hat{N} = \frac{N}{1-a},$$

where $a \geq 0$ is the number used for curving up the grades of all of you, and

$\hat{N} \geq N$ (because $a \geq 0$) is your adjusted gross numerical grade

- that is, your gross numerical grade will never be adjust to a value lower than the value without adjustment.

The value of a will be announced when the grades are all posted after the final exam.

- Below is the correspondence between the adjusted gross numerical grade and the letter grade:

$$\text{Letter Grade} = \begin{cases} \text{A} & \text{if } \hat{N} \geq 90 \\ \text{A-} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [87, 90) \\ \text{B+} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [84, 87) \\ \text{B} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [81, 84) \\ \text{B-} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [78, 81) \\ \text{C+} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [75, 78) \\ \text{C} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [72, 75) \\ \text{C-} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [69, 72) \\ \text{D+} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [66, 69) \\ \text{D} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [63, 66) \\ \text{D-} & \text{if } \hat{N} \in [60, 63) \\ \text{F} & \text{if } \hat{N} < 60 \end{cases}.$$

Please note that, given the correspondence above, you are not competing against each other (your classmates) to earn higher grades, and it is possible for all of you to get decent letter grades if you are with sufficiently high raw grades of quizzes and exams. Thus, you are encouraged to study and work together whenever possible and rightful (e.g., organizing study groups, working together on quizzes) so as to make improvements in a mutually beneficial manner.

Finally, please be aware that your gross numerical grades (both with and without adjustment ones) and letter grades will be posted on Canvas during the regrading period for the final exam before your letter grades become final and are submitted to the registrar.

5 Other General Academic Guidelines and Resources

- Quantitative Reasoning Flag

This course carries the Quantitative Reasoning flag. Quantitative Reasoning courses are designed to equip you with skills that are necessary for understanding the types of quantitative arguments you will regularly encounter in your adult and professional life. You should therefore expect a substantial portion of your grade to come from your use of quantitative skills to analyze real-world problems.

- Statement on Academic Integrity

All of your participation in this class is expected to be in accordance with the UT Honor Code:

“The University of Texas at Austin strives to create a dynamic and engaging community of teaching and learning where students feel intellectually challenged; build knowledge and skills; and develop critical thinking, creativity, and intellectual curiosity. As a part of this community, it is important to engage in assignments, exams, and other work for your classes with openness, integrity, and a willingness to make mistakes and learn from them.

The UT Austin honor code champions these principles:

I pledge, as a member of the University of Texas community, to do my work honestly, respectfully, and through the intentional pursuit of learning and scholarship.

The honor code affirmation includes three additional principles that elaborate on the core theme:

- I pledge to be honest about what I create and to acknowledge what I use that belongs to others.
- I pledge to value the process of learning in addition to the outcome, while celebrating and learning from mistakes.
- This code encompasses all of the academic and scholarly endeavors of the university community.

The honor code is more than a set of rules, it reflects the values that are foundational to your academic community. By affirming and embracing the honor code, you are both upholding the integrity of your work and contributing to a campus culture of trust and respect.”

Students who violate University rules on academic misconduct are subject to the student conduct process. A student found responsible for academic misconduct may be assigned both a status sanction and a grade impact for the course. The grade impact could range from a zero on the assignment in question up to a failing grade in the course. A status sanction can range from a written warning, probation, deferred suspension and/or dismissal from the University. To learn more about academic integrity standards, tips for avoiding a potential academic misconduct violation, and the overall conduct process, please visit the Student Conduct and Academic Integrity website at: <http://deanofstudents.utexas.edu/conduct>

- Sharing of Course Materials is Prohibited

No materials used in this class, including, but not limited to, lecture hand-outs, assessments (quizzes, exams, papers, projects, homework assignments), in-class materials, review sheets, and additional problem sets, may be shared online or with anyone outside of the class unless you have my explicit, written permission. Unauthorized sharing of materials may facilitate cheating. The University is aware of the sites used for sharing materials, and any materials found online that are associated with you, or any suspected unauthorized sharing of materials, will be reported to Student Conduct and Academic Integrity in the Office of the Dean of Students. These reports can result in initiation of the student conduct process and include charge(s) for academic misconduct, potentially resulting in sanctions, including a grade impact.

- Use of Email for Official Correspondence to Students

All students should become familiar with the University’s official email student notification policy. It is the student’s responsibility to keep the University informed of any changes in his or her email address. Students are expected to check email on a frequent and regular basis in order to stay current with University communications, recognizing that certain communications may be time-critical. This includes emails from instructors. It is recommended that email be checked daily.

- Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

The university is committed to creating an accessible and inclusive learning environment consistent with university policy and federal and state law. Please let me know if you experience any barriers to learning so I can work with you to ensure you have equal opportunity to participate fully in this course. If you are a student with a disability, or think you may have a disability, and need accommodations please contact Disability and Access (D&A). Please refer to D&A’s website for contact and more information: <http://diversity.utexas.edu/disability/>. If you are already registered with D&A, please deliver your Accommodation Letter to me as early as possible in the semester so we can discuss your approved accommodations and needs in this course.

- Religious Holy Days

By UT Austin policy, you must notify me of your pending absence for a religious holy day as far in advance as possible of the date of observance. If you must miss a class, an examination, a work assignment, or a project in order to observe a religious holy day, you will be given a reasonable

compensation or an opportunity to complete the missed work within a reasonable time after the absence.

- Title IX

Title IX is a segment of the Education Amendments of 1972 and makes it clear that violence, harassment, or discrimination based on sex and gender are Civil Rights offenses subject to the same kinds of accountability and the same kinds of support applied to offenses against other protected categories such as race, national origin, sexuality, disability, etc. If you or someone you know has been harassed or assaulted, please don't hesitate to speak to anyone on our teaching team. You can also find useful resources at <https://www.utexas.edu/student-affairs/policies/title-ix>

- Counseling and Mental Health Center

As a student, you may experience a range of challenges that can interfere with learning, such as strained relationships, increased anxiety, substance use, feeling down, difficulty concentrating and/or lack of motivation. These mental health concerns or stressful events may diminish your academic performance and/or reduce your ability to participate in daily activities. Services are available here at UT, and treatment does work. The UT Counseling and Mental Health Center (<http://chmc.utexas.edu/>) provides counseling, psychiatric, consultation, and prevention services that facilitate students' academic and life goals and enhance their personal growth and well-being. The CMHC crisis line is available 24/7/365 at 512-471-2255; our COFA Care Counselor Nathan Langfitt can be reached at the direct line 512-471-0392. A wonderful resource at the CMHC is the MindBody Lab, a self-paced environment designed to help UT students explore various resources for improving their emotional and physical health. The Lab currently features audio and video instruction on a variety of topics, including sleep issues; food and body image; health and well-being; relaxation and meditation. Most of this material is experiential, enabling students to follow along and practice the skills as they are being discussed.

- Emergency Evacuation

From the Office of Campus Safety and Security (<http://www.utexas.edu/safety/>):

- Occupants of buildings on The University of Texas at Austin campus are required to evacuate buildings when a fire alarm is activated. Alarm activation or announcement requires exiting and assembling outside.
- Familiarize yourself with all exit doors of each classroom and building you may occupy. Remember that the nearest exit door may not be the one you used when entering the building.
- Students requiring assistance in evacuation shall inform their instructor in writing during the first week of class.
- In the event of an evacuation, follow the instruction of faculty or class instructors.
- Do not re-enter a building unless given instructions by the following: Austin Fire Department, The University of Texas at Austin Police Department, or Fire Prevention Services office.
- Behavior Concerns Advice Line (BCAL): 512-232-5050
- Link to information regarding emergency evacuation routes and emergency procedures can be found at: utexas.edu/emergency